

SGSU Executive Exit Reports: 2025-2026

President (Luis Sierra):

As president, I oversaw and led the organization of the various academic and social events (Game Nights, award workshops, Pub Night, pancake day, secret santa, etc.) throughout the 2025-2026 term. Most of these built upon the traditions from previous years with minor adjustments, while others were completely new, such as the Chess Tournament, or the SGSU Logo competition, which led to a new logo for our union that can be found on the SGSU website. The flagship event was once again Research Day. Held towards the end of the winter semester, it aims to showcase the work done by graduate students in the broad field of statistics. This year we managed to get participation from four different universities in Southern Ontario, which along with the reception held after the event, served to expand its networking opportunities. I also acted as a liaison between the graduate students and department staff, faculty, and other external institutions, while being responsible for the communications sent on behalf of the SGSU to the graduate students. This also included meetings with the DoSS Chair and providing input on the new MSc program. I was able to secure extra funding and resources from DoSS, which were used for award workshops and Research day expenses, "hotelling" desks for the MSc students, and support for the Directed Reading Program. I hope such resources continue to be available in future years. Finally, I advocated for and designed the new relationship between the union and the MFI students, as well as advising them on how to constitute their own student union. This also came with changes in our union's constitution regarding its composition and election rules.

Vice President, Internal (Elijah French):

As Vice-President, Internal, my main duty was to represent the SGSU within the GSU. This involved attending four assembly meetings throughout the academic year and ensuring our head-grant applications were up to date. I also managed communications between the GSU and the department to clarify the membership status of MFI students, which included co-spearheading an SGSU assembly meeting to resolve the matter democratically. Additionally, I assisted with organizing and running various events throughout the year, including an OGS workshop, an NSERC workshop, and Park Day.

Treasurer (Bernard Miskic)

As Treasurer, my primary responsibilities included managing the SGSU's bank account, applying for head grants, and handling all bookkeeping and reimbursements. This year, the SGSU received \$1,684 from the UTGSU in head grant payments, distributed as \$1,302 on December 22nd and \$382 on May 1st. We began the year with a starting balance of \$5,003 and finished with a closing balance of \$4,277. This resulted in a net deficit of \$726, successfully achieving our goal of running a small, planned deficit to responsibly utilize previous surplus funds. Throughout the year, I maintained accurate financial records and ensured our operations aligned with the SGSU constitution and UTGSU financial rules. Beyond my financial duties, I thoroughly enjoyed participating in our social events, particularly the board game nights.

Vice-President, Events (Leo Watson):

As Vice President of Events, my primary goal was to foster community and create opportunities for bonding among SGSU members. I served as the lead organizer for our annual Pub Night, which was successfully hosted at a new venue, W Burger Bar, this year. In addition to this, I assisted the executive team with various other initiatives throughout the year, such as Game Night, and I greatly appreciated the opportunity to collaborate and connect with a wider range of people within the department.

Vice-President, Academic (Vinky Wang):

As Vice-President, Academic, my primary goal was to engage with and support the SGSU and department community. I organized key academic events, such as the SGSU Research Day and the OGS workshop, while also assisting with social gatherings like pub nights and board game nights. Additionally, I coordinated themed office decorations and provided snacks for occasions like Halloween and Valentine's Day to foster a welcoming environment. Overall, I greatly enjoyed organizing these events and collaborating with such a wonderful executive team throughout the year

Sports Director (PH Chan):

As Sports Representative, I focused on promoting athletic and recreational engagement within our graduate community by organizing and supporting a variety of interactive events. My main initiatives included coordinating the ping pong tournament, running the SGSU logo contest, and organizing the reception following Research Day. Additionally, I assisted with the chess tournament and established dedicated Slack channels to help members connect over shared sports interests.

First Year Representative (Pat Chimtanoo):

As First Year Representative, my primary duty was to represent the interests of first-year Ph.D. students and serve as the main point of contact for peer inquiries to ensure a smooth transition for the new cohort. Throughout my term, I coordinated event schedules with the executive team to align with first-year academic commitments and actively promoted events to increase engagement. Additionally, I assisted in organizing and executing various social and academic events, including Pancake Day, Board Game Nights, Pub Nights, and Research Day. Overall, I thoroughly enjoyed working alongside the other executive members to turn our ideas into action and help build a stronger, more connected community.

MSc Representative (Mahdi Zamani):

As MSc Representative, my main objective was to advocate for the needs of master's students, particularly by pushing for dedicated desk space through departmental and UTGSU discussions. Beyond this advocacy, I actively participated in organizing and executing several community events, including Pancake Day, Research Day, and Park Day. Overall, I greatly enjoyed being part of the executive team and contributing to the student community